Standard deviation and outliers

Data science · Level 2 · Lesson 2



In this lesson you will

- Read a standard deviation.
- Flag outliers with the IQR rule.
- Check outliers before acting.

Key ideas

- SD: typical distance from the mean.
- Outlier: beyond 1.5 × IQR.
- Check, don’t delete.

Outlier detectives

1. Warm-up (5 min): Same average?
2. Find (10 min): The fences.
3. Investigate (10 min): Mistake or real?
4. Wrap-up (5 min): What did you find out?

Let's discuss

1. What does a big standard deviation mean?
2. Why not delete outliers?
3. Which outlier surprised you?

Exit ticket

- Q1 is 20 and Q3 is 30. Write the two fences.